Sarah Elizabeth Gillespie

PhD Student · Khoury College of Computer Sciences

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Education

Northeastern University: Khoury College of Computer Sciences *Boston, MA*

PhD Computer Science *2023 - present*

- Advisor: Dr. Christo Wilson
- Khoury Distinguished Fellowship
- Member and Organizer, Khoury Women's PhD Group
- Coursework: Usable Security and Privacy, Medical Device Cybersecurity, Human-Computer Interaction, Wireless and Mobile Systems Security, Regulation of Technology in the Digital Economy, Web Development, Statistical Methods for Comp Sci

Smith College *Northampton, MA*

BA Quantitative Economics; Statistical and Data Sciences *2018 - 2022*

- Double Major: Quantitative Economics and Statistical and Data Sciences
- Special Study: Algorithm fairness teachable unit supervised by Professor Katherine Kinnaird

Professional Experience

2023-2026	**PhD Candidate & Research Assistant**, Khoury College of Computer Sciences, Northeastern University
Spring 2026	**Teaching Assistant: CS4700 Network Fundamentals**, Khoury College of Computer Sciences, Northeastern University
2022-2023	**Metrologist / Quality Engineer**, Sartorius Stedim Biotech
2020-2021	**Market Monitoring Intern**, ISO New England Inc.
2019	**Intern**, Juris Productions

Publications

Published

Zagzon, N.*, **Gillespie, S.E.***, Veara, J., Patel, D., Choffnes, D., Mislove, A., Ranganathan, A., Sapiezynski, P., Wilson, C. 2026. Automatic Transmission: An Empirical Study of Data Privacy in the Connected Vehicle Ecosystem (IMC '26). *Co-first authors on this work.

Gunawan, J., **Gillespie, S.E.**, Choffnes, D., Hartzog, W., Wilson, C. 2025. Promises, Promises: Understanding Claims Made in Social Robot Consumer Experiences. Proceedings of the 2025 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '25).

Michel, S., Kaur, S., **Gillespie, S.E.**, Gleason, J., Wilson, C., Ghosh, A. 2025. "It's not a representation of me": Examining Accent Bias and Digital Exclusion in Synthetic AI Voice Services. Proceedings of the 2025 ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT '25).

Gillespie, S.E., Wilson, C. 2024. Investigating the Datafication of Your Car. IEEE Security 8th Workshop on Technology and Consumer Protection (ConPro '24).

In Review

Investigating Connected Vehicle Privacy Through the Lens of Data Subject Access Requests

In Prep

AI Social Robots: Safety analysis regarding response content, self-harm, and privacy

Awards, Fellowships, & Grants

2026-2028	**Trainee Fellowship: Platforms for Exchange and Allocation of Resources (PEAR)**, National Science Foundation Research Traineeship Program
2023-2024	**Khoury Distinguished Fellowship**, Northeastern University, Khoury College of Computer Sciences
2022	**Five College Statistics Prize for outstanding service to statistics**, Smith College, Statistical and Data Sciences Program

Presentations

Conference Presentations

April 2026. *Privacy in the Rearview: Empirical Analysis of Connected Vehicle Data Exposure*. Khoury Security and Privacy Day, Boston, MA, USA.

May 2024. *Investigating the Datafication of Your Car*. IEEE Security 8th Workshop on Technology and Consumer Protection (ConPro '24), San Francisco, CA, USA.

Conference Attendance

ACM CHI 2025 and 2026 - Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems

PETS 2025 - Privacy Enhancing Technologies Symposium

CS Law 2024 - Computer Science and Law Conference

IEEE S&P 2024 - IEEE Symposium on Security and Privacy

Outreach & Professional Development

Service and Outreach

2023-Present	**Khoury Women's PhD Group**, Organizer	*Boston, MA, USA*
2025	**Mon(IoT)r Lab**, Student Recruitment	*Boston, MA, USA*
2021	**Smithies in Statistical and Data Sciences**, President	*Northampton, MA, USA*

Development

Algorithm Fairness Teachable Unit, Smith College Special Study supervised by Professor Katherine Kinnaird. Developed comprehensive curriculum on creating transparent, trustworthy, and fair machine learning algorithms with focus on preventing discrimination against protected classes. Curriculum includes different definitions of fairness, mathematics behind trust scores, and hands-on implementation labs.

Research Interests

Consumer Protection and AI Ethics
Algorithm Auditing
Privacy and Tracking
AI Social Robots
Dark Patterns
Datafication and IoT Devices